

the commit we want to go back to permanently ❸. We check the status again and see we're on the main branch with nothing to commit ❹. When we look at the log again, we see that we're at the commit we wanted to start over from ❺.

Deleting the Repository

Sometimes you'll mess up your repository's history and won't know how to recover it. If this happens, first consider asking for help using the approaches discussed in Appendix C. If you can't fix it and you're working on a solo project, you can continue working with the files but get rid of the project's history by deleting the `.git` directory. This won't affect the current state of any of the files, but it will delete all commits, so you won't be able to check out any other states of the project.

To do this, either open a file browser and delete the `.git` repository or delete it from the command line. Afterward, you'll need to start over with a fresh repository to start tracking your changes again. Here's what this entire process looks like in a terminal session:

```
❶ git_practice$ git status
On branch main
nothing to commit, working directory clean
❷ git_practice$ rm -rf .git/
❸ git_practice$ git status
fatal: Not a git repository (or any of the parent directories): .git
❹ git_practice$ git init
Initialized empty Git repository in git_practice/.git/
❺ git_practice$ git status
On branch main
No commits yet

Untracked files:
  (use "git add <file>..." to include in what will be committed)
    .gitignore
    hello_git.py

nothing added to commit but untracked files present (use "git add" to track)
❻ git_practice$ git add .
git_practice$ git commit -m "Starting over."
[main (root-commit) 14ed9db] Starting over.
 2 files changed, 5 insertions(+)
 create mode 100644 .gitignore
 create mode 100644 hello_git.py
❼ git_practice$ git status
On branch main
nothing to commit, working tree clean
git_practice$
```

We first check the status and see that we have a clean working directory ❶. Then we use the command `rm -rf .git/` to delete the `.git` directory (del `.git` on Windows) ❷. When we check the status after deleting the `.git`